

Syllabus ISM - Spring 2026

Professor: Kathleen Fitzgerald
Phone: 1-312-206-7984
Email: kathleen.fitzgerald@chicagobooth.edu

Teaching Assistant: Catherine Redmayne
Email: credmayne@uchicago.edu

Course Description

Integrated Strategic Management (ISM) is designed around an advanced simulation developed by Booth in which participants focus on managing a business. Students compete in teams to grow a struggling start-up into a valuable company poised for IPO, merger, LBO, MBO, or some other strategy determined by the team. This course gives students the opportunity to integrate and apply knowledge from several disciplines simultaneously, providing insight into the complexity of real-world business situations and hands-on experience that is hard to come by in more theoretical courses. To succeed, students draw upon material learned in microeconomics, operations, competitive strategy, financial accounting, managerial accounting, corporate finance, negotiations, marketing, governance, managerial decision-making, and other subjects in the Booth curriculum. The outcome of the simulation depends entirely on the interaction between the strategies that the separate businesses employ, and on their ability to effectively execute these strategies. Success relies on a team's ability to work together, make effective decisions, and compete or collaborate with other teams.

Course Activities

Activity	Information
Classes	Attendance and participation are required for all class times. Please refer to the table on page 3 for details. Classes and office hours will be held in person. Announcements will be posted to the Canvas home page, emailed to the class via Canvas Inbox, or both.
Game Play	Students will need a computer (not a tablet or mobile device) to access and play the simulation. Please bring your laptop to class every day. Links to each game will be posted on Canvas. We will use the in-game chat to communicate during game play. Please refer to the table on page 3 for additional information.

Class Times and Attendance

Attendance is mandatory for this course. This includes lecture and required game times. Please plan your schedule around attending and participating in all classes and scheduled game sessions. Any unexcused absence will result in an incomplete in the course.

Teaching Assistant

Catherine Redmayne: Catherine is a fourth-year undergraduate student in the College studying Economics and Psychology. Her interests lie in strategy, investing and behavioural finance. Last summer, she interned at a boutique investment management firm in Chicago, positioned specifically within the North American energy sector. Additionally, she assisted a UK-based accountancy roll-up with its internal business development and future M&A strategy. Post-graduation, she will be joining the Brattle group, an economic consulting firm, as part of their Securities practice in Chicago.

Best Practices for Success in this Course

- **Active participation in all classes and game play** is extremely helpful in feeling connected and making the most of the experience, as each class and assignment builds on what comes before, and students who invest the time up front often tell us afterward that it greatly contributed to their enjoyment of the class.
- **Establishing an organized decision-making and conflict-resolution** process as a team will help you avoid frustrations and move forward effectively in the fast-paced world of the game. This has been a key competitive advantage for teams in the past.
- While splitting work on group assignments can be unavoidable, it is important to make sure that all team members are **familiar with all course concepts and aspects of the game**. Teams often find it necessary to reorganize their roles in the middle of the game as their business grows, and having team members who are **cross-trained on functional roles** in the game is very helpful.
- **Enjoy the ride!** Things may not always go according to plan. Focus on the positive and do your best to enjoy yourself while applying what you have learned during your time here at Booth.
- **Ask for help early.** We are available to help you with anything you need.

Chicago Booth Honor Code

"No student shall represent another's work as their own. No person shall receive disallowed assistance of any sort, or provide disallowed assistance to another student, at any time before, during, or after an examination or with respect to other graded work for a course." Students are required to sign the following honor pledge on each submitted assignment: *"I (we) pledge my (our) honor that I (we) have not violated the Chicago Booth Honor Code on this examination (assignment)."*

Accommodations for Disabilities

The University of Chicago is committed to ensuring equitable access to our academic programs and services. Students with disabilities who have been approved for the use of academic accommodations by [Student Disability Services](#) (SDS) and need a reasonable accommodation(s) to participate fully in this course should follow the procedures established by SDS for using accommodations. Timely notifications are required in order to ensure that your accommodations can be implemented. Please contact Kathleen to discuss access needs in this class after you have completed the SDS procedures for requesting accommodations.

Student Disability Services: Phone: +1 (773) 702-6000, disabilities@uchicago.edu

Course Schedule

Date	Lecture / Video	Game	Homework
Pre-Course	N/A	No game	Read Monopoly Game case brief Read Trading Game case brief Review Gleacher Game Player Manual Read A Note on Microeconomics for Strategists Assignment 1, due by 3pm, April 12, 2026
Class 1 Sunday	Class time: 3:00-6:00pm Microeconomics, Statistics, Operations	Monopoly game Trading game	Required game play: 7:00-9:00pm Assignment 2, due by 9am on April 13, 2026
Class 2 Monday	Class time: 3:00-6:00pm Operations, Financial Accounting	Production game	Required game play: 7:00-9:00pm Assignment 3, due by 9am on April 14, 2026
Class 3 Tuesday	Class time: 3:00-6:00pm Marketing, Finance, Strategy	Practice game	Required game play: 7:00-9:00pm Assignment 4, due by 9am on April 15, 2026
Class 4 Wednesday	Class time: 3:00-6:00pm Analyze Practice Game Prepare for Competition	Competition	Required game play: 7:00-9:00pm Assignment 5, due by 9am on April 16, 2026
Class 5 Thursday	Class time: 3:00-6:00pm Game Analysis	Competition	Required game play: 7:00-9:00pm No assignment tonight
Class 6 Friday	Class time: TBD Wrap Up	Wrap-Up Final Project	Assignment 6 and Final Project due by 11:59pm on May 3, 2026

Course Materials

All course materials may be found on the course Canvas site.

Course Assessment

Your overall performance for the course will be determined as shown in the table below. All assignments are group work unless indicated otherwise. Assignments are designed to help you understand course concepts or further your progress in the game. Completing assignments on time is essential to your success in the course. We suggest that you do not wait until the last minute to submit an assignment, as the deadlines below will not be extended.

Item	Individual or Group	Deadline (HK Time)	Points
Assignment 1	Individual	Sunday, April 12 by 3:00pm	10
Assignment 2	Group	Monday, April 13 by 9am	10
Assignment 3	Group	Tuesday, April 14 by 9am	10
Assignment 4	Group	Wednesday, April 15 by 9am	5
Assignment 5	Group	Thursday, April 16 by 9am	5
Assignment 6	Individual	Sunday, May 3 by 11:59pm	10
Final Project	Group	Sunday, May 3 by 11:59pm	30
Participation	Individual	Ongoing	10
Game Performance	Individual	Ongoing	10

All assignments need to be submitted via Canvas by the deadline.

- Assignments will be posted on the course Canvas site.
- Your final project will include a summary and analysis of your decisions and outcomes during the simulation, as well as a projection for the future and a valuation of the business.

Re-grading Policy:

If any student wishes to contest a grade for any submitted work she/he should adhere to the following procedures:

1. The re-grade request must be made within a week after the graded work has been returned.
2. The request must be in writing with the student outlining the specific areas of the work that requires re-grading including the reason(s) for the re-grade. All requests must be signed and dated by the student (or by all team members if the work being re-graded is a group assignment).
3. The submitted work will be re-graded in its entirety and therefore the contested grade might go up, down, or stay the same. Therefore, a re-grade request is not a free option.